Crafts Council of India

"...ensuring sustainability of artisans and their craft..."

Newsletter of the Crafts Council of India January - June 2026

CRAFTS COUNCIL OF INDIA



CONTENTS

1. Editorial: *Pushpa Chari*..... 2
2. Tribute: Vijaya Rajan..... 4
3. Economics of Indian Craft: *Gita Ram*..... 6
4. Artisanspeak: Interview, *Geetha Rao*..... 8
5. Revival Stories..... 10
   - *Satgaon Kantha*
   - *The Art of Pajni*
6. Personal Craft Story..... 14
   - Kagzipura: *Rukmini Amirapu*
   - Memory I Cherish: *Rathi Jha*
7. Craft Personality..... 16
   Judy Frater
8. CCI Events..... 17
   - *Chettinad Symposium*
   - *Crafts Bazaar*
   - *Kamala Awards*
   - *Tari - The Loom*
9. Other Council Reports..... 22
10. Affiliated Councils..... 32

EDITORIAL

A New Look at CCI News

It is with a heavy heart that I place on record the passing away of Vijaya Rajan in Chennai on 9th April, 2026. She served the Crafts Council of India (CCI) as its Chairperson for more than 4 decades with single-minded passion and dedication, helming pathbreaking programmes for its growth and development and that of the artisans. Her humane and nurturing nature made Vijaya "friend, philosopher and guide" to countless artisans. The Crafts Council of India bids farewell to this towering figure of craft volunteerism with the hope that the footprints she leaves behind will be followed by CCI in the years to come.

We unveil CCI's news-filled and sharp new look Newsletter with a report of the launch in Delhi of 'Economics of Indian Crafts: Estimating Employment and Value Added in the Handicraft and Handloom Sector', a paper prepared by the Institute for Human Development in collaboration with CCI. This document marks an important step towards making India's artisans visible in economic discourse.

Carrying forward CCI's vision of 'revival, reimagination and innovation' of the living craft traditions of India, with a focus on the artisans whose hands shape them, we carry interviews with Shilpi Arun Yogiraj who created the captivating 'Ram Lalla' for the Ram temple in Ayodhya, with Moli Haldar who revived the nearly vanished Satgaon quilt of West Bengal along with a short sketch of Tulsa Bai Dhakle, the one-woman revivalist of Garbha Reshmi saris. 'Craft Personality' features Judy Frater and an evocative new feature that has been introduced, comprises members' craft tales of serendipitous encounters with rare crafts in remote parts of India or of their own unique craft journeys.



At the launch of the report on 'Economics of Indian Craft', New Delhi, April 2026



Kamala Samman Awardee Shri B. Krishnamoorthy



Crafts Bazaar, February 2026

Crisp and concise reportage of the CCI Symposium held in craft-rich Chettinad follows, along with a walk through the 'Craft Bazaar' and 'Tari - the Loom' textile exhibition, where we join in proud salute to the artisans and weavers of the country. We also salute the winners of CCI's Kamala Awards which were presented to the awardees at a special event held in Chennai.

Needless to say, the 11 State Councils, which are an integral part of the CCI family, mirror both the commitment and vision of CCI. A brief look at their work and projects give an insight into the vision and breadth of their commitment to crafts and craftspersons in their respective regions.

Welcome to the new CCI Newsletter in which concept, colour, word and image come together to craft the ongoing CCI story!

Pushpa Chari



Smt. Vijaya Rajan
1936 - 2026

Smt. Vijaya Rajan: A Tribute

Born into a distinguished family steeped in scholarship and tradition, Vijaya Rajan grew up surrounded by beautiful craft objects which defined the family's lifestyle and ethos. With training in Bharatanatyam and choosing Ancient Indian History for her postgraduate studies, perhaps it would not be too farfetched to say that craft chose Vijaya Rajan to be its champion. For Vijaya it was a natural progression to step into the world of crafts.

Smt. Kamaladevi Chattopadhyay saw her potential and entrusted her with the role of the first Honorary Secretary of the Crafts Council of India in 1976 and its Chairperson in 1978, a position she held with great distinction for more than four decades.

Dedicated and passionately devoted to the cause of the country's crafts and its artisans, as Chairperson of CCI, Vijaya Rajan spearheaded leading landmark programmes, focusing on crafts as an eco-friendly, sustainable and financially rewarding profession, as well as a proud heritage calling.

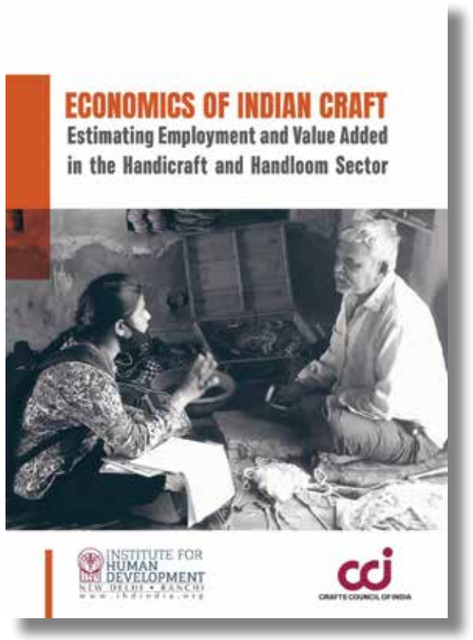
The breadth and depth of the programmes helmed by Vijaya Rajan, the dedication and efficiency with which they were presented and their reach to numerous artisans were monumental achievements in themselves. They also earned CCI the sobriquet of being the best Craft NGO of the country.

Vijaya Rajan held the prestigious position of the President of WCC-APR, impacting the growth of craft in the region, as well as bringing in new members into the World Craft Council's fold.

Meeting artisans across India, reaching out to them through the State Councils, joining in their celebrations and helping them in significant ways in their hour of need was the driving force, behind Vijaya Rajan's engagement with crafts.

She walked in the Craft Council of India's universe with dignity, poise and a clear sense of purpose. We will miss her.

Pushpa Chari





Emeritus Chairperson speaking at the launch of the report

Craft Economics

CCI has been very concerned about the lack of robust data on the number of artisans in India for many years. While some sources put the number of artisans at 18 million, others extend the numbers to 30 million, 100 million-even 200 million. CCI's efforts to close the data gap dates to 2009, when pilot surveys first put the issue before India's Planning Commission which led to the inclusion of a column for Handlooms and Handicrafts in its Economic Census of 2013.

CCI and many of the affiliated Councils had helped them in the training of enumerators.

After years of looking for funds to do a proper study, with the help of Tarun Das, Past President, Confederation of Indian Industry (CII), CCI got CSR funding to do a pilot study.

The study has taken a little less than three years. The CCI and the Institute for Human Development (IHD) have just released a major new study of India's handicraft and handloom sector on 18th May, 2026 at the India International Centre, New Delhi. Titled *Economics of Indian Craft: Estimating Employment and Value Added in the Handicraft and Handloom Sector*, it is the first field-based, statistically credible attempt to measure what is widely described as India's second-largest source of livelihood after agriculture.

The study surveyed 4,659 handloom and handicraft units across rural and urban locations in five states: Assam, Rajasthan, Tamil Nadu, Uttar Pradesh, and West Bengal. The research team was led by Dr. GC Manna, former Director-General of India's National Statistical Office.

Some key findings:

The sector operates through the year and is not seasonal as assumed earlier. Ownership of the units by women is high.



Textiles Minister Shri Giriraj Singh releasing the report

In the five states studied, 26 per cent of the total manufacturing workforce is engaged in the sector.

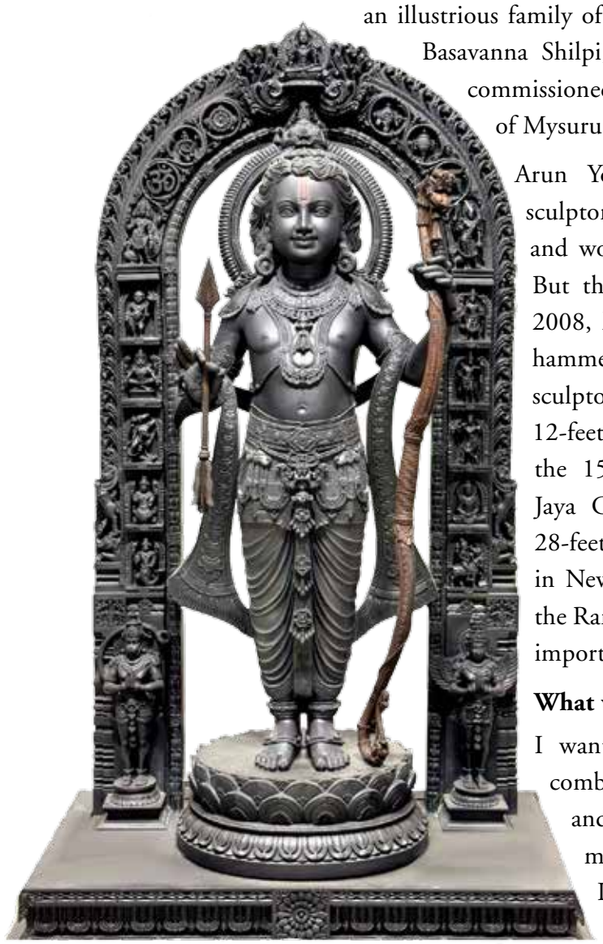
What is important to note is that the average daily income is around Rs. 270 per day, well below the statutory minimum wage for skilled agricultural workers. Most units rely on unpaid family labour.

Most units are unaware of government schemes for training and support, and have minimum access to finance.

The study also proposes a replicable methodology designed for adoption by other states and, ultimately, for integration into national accounting systems.

Shilpi Arun Yogiraj – Karnataka's renowned sculptor speaks to Geetha Rao

Arun Yogiraj is a fifth-generation stone sculptor, who hails from an illustrious family of sculptors from Mysuru. His grandfather, Basavanna Shilpi, was a Mysuru Palace Artist, who was commissioned to make idols for many of the temples of Mysuru.



The 51-inch Ram Lalla idol in the Ram Temple in Ayodhya

Arun Yogiraj was a competent, but unusual sculptor. He did his MBA from Mysore University and worked for a private company for a while. But the pull of his calling was strong and in 2008, he quit his job, picked up his chisel and hammer and went back to being a full-time sculptor. He was commissioned to sculpt the 12-feet idol of Adi Shankaracharya, at Kedarnath, the 15-feet white marble statue of Maharaja Jaya Chamaraja Wadiyar in Mysuru and the 28-feet statue of Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose, in New Delhi. The 51-inch Ram Lalla idol, in the Ram Temple in Ayodhya, is for him, his most important work.

What was your vision for the Ram Lalla idol?

I wanted to make an idol that portrayed a combination of the innocence of childhood and the grace of the divine. The authorities made a studio for me in Ayodhya and I settled down to work. I did my home-work and studied the *Shilpa Shashtras* (foundational manuals for sculpture and other arts and crafts), *shlokas* (verses) and instructions laid down by my ancestors.

I studied the anatomy of several five-year-old children, especially the facial muscles. I understood that geometry was God. My grandfather had taught me that eyes are the most important feature of an idol and have to be carved with great care and delicacy. The tools that should be used, are a gold chisel and a silver hammer. The opening of the eyes of the idol is a sacred ritual, *netronmilanala*.





Shilpi Arun Yogiraj at work

How did you choose the stone for sculpting the idol?

I sourced the black stone (schist), Krishna Shila, named after the dark-hued God, Krishna, that is widely found in the H.D. Kote area around Mysuru. Several tonnes of stone were mined, cut to size and left open for a day, when the oxidisation process took place and the stone hardened. The stone is also known for its unique properties, being water-resistant and non-reactive to acidic substances.

Did you meditate before you began to carve?

For me, just carving the stone was my meditation! The idol of Ram Lalla that I sculpted, weighing around 150 kgs, was that of a five-year-old boy, in a standing posture, with a bow and arrow in each hand, placed on a lotus, on a base, under which was a stone-locking key that glued the idol to the floor. The completed idol was transported to the *garbha griha* (sanctum sanctorum) of the Ram Temple, with the help of a crane by the appointed technical team of Larsen & Toubro.

How did you feel at the end of the *prana pratishta*, consecration of the idol?

I felt that I was the luckiest person on earth, for having had this unique opportunity. I felt truly blessed and offered my deepest thanksgiving to God and my ancestors.

The Story of the Satgaon Quilt

Satgaon quilts are rare, historical embroidered quilts which were produced in Bengal, in the Saptagram/Hooghly district, during the 16th and 17th centuries, specifically catering to the Portuguese market. Known as colchas, they feature yellow tussar silk embroidery on white cotton fabric, depicting a blend of European Biblical/ mythological scenes and Indian motifs. Today they are a nearly vanished craft.



Moli Haldar

Tanima Sinha, Manager Artisana, speaks to Moli Haldar.

Thank you for speaking with us today. To begin, what inspired you to create the Satgaon Quilt?

The inspiration came from Satgaon a place rich in history but largely forgotten today. I wanted to bring its story back to life through something tactile and intimate, like a quilt.

Why did you choose a quilt as your medium?

Quilts are intertwined with memories. In Bengal especially, through kantha, we've always told stories through layers of fabric. We also had Bengal's own Nakshi Kantha. Interestingly, kantha was mentioned in *Sri Chaitanya Charitamrita*, in the late 16th century. The idea of stitching together fragments of cloth, with intricate running stitch art, felt very similar to reconstructing Satgaon's lost past.







Varied motifs on the Satgaon quilts

What kind of imagery or motifs do you choose to weave into the quilt?

Along with boats and the river, I've included motifs of soldiers' figures that hint at protection, conflict, and the shifting powers that once passed through Satgaon. There are also depictions of traders, coins, and market scenes to suggest its bustling commercial life. Interestingly, some visual references such as certain ship forms, costumes, and cross-like symbols are inspired by what we've gathered from Portuguese accounts and influences, since the Portuguese were among the foreign traders who came to Satgaon. The Sufis too mentioned kantha.

That adds a fascinating layer of history. Does the process itself hold meaning for you?

Absolutely. The slow, repetitive stitching becomes almost meditative. It mirrors the act of remembering: patient, layered and sometimes incomplete. Some kanthas incorporate folk themes, special borders, Hindu raths, Muslim mosques and more.

Do you see this work as purely artistic, or also historical?

It sits somewhere in between. It's not documentation in the academic sense, but it is a form of emotional archiving—preserving what history books may overlook.

How do viewers usually respond to the Satgaon Quilt?

Many people feel a sense of curiosity and quiet nostalgia. Even if they don't know Satgaon, they connect with the idea of something once vibrant now slipping into silence.

What would you like people to take away from your work?

I hope they reflect on forgotten places and stories—and realise that history isn't always grand monuments; sometimes, it survives in threads and textures.

Contributed by Crafts Council of West Bengal

Tulsa Bai Dhakle: One-woman Revivalist of Pajni

Tulsa Bai's story is one of passion and persistence. From dawn until the fading light of the evening, she worked on the craft of Pajni, a special sizing and stretching process of the cotton warp used to create the distinctive Garbha Reshmi saris. As a young bride, she was not expected to work outdoors where the craft traditionally takes place. "I used to learn Pajni when my husband went for a bath," she remembers, revealing her determination to keep this traditional knowledge alive.

With the passage of time, silk warps, being quicker and easier to handle, replaced the fragile cotton that required meticulous attention. And, the younger generation turned away from the physically demanding work. By the end of the twentieth century the tradition survived in the hands of just one woman, Tulsa Bai.

When *Women Weave*, through the Handloom School, set out to revive Pajni, Tulsa Bai stepped forward—not only as a teacher but as a guardian of memory. "I want to teach the technique to everyone who wants to learn," she says. She is hopeful that "Pajni will now survive".



Tulsa Bai Dhakle



The art of warp preparation in handloom weaving



A Slice of History – Handmade Paper in Kagzipura

During a recent trip to the spectacular Ajanta and Ellora caves, I had the rare opportunity to visit Kagzipura—a tiny village steeped in history, located near Ellora. True to its name, Kagzipura has nurtured a remarkable 700-year-old tradition of handmade paper-making.

The origins of this craft can be traced back to 1327, when Muhammad bin Tughlaq shifted his capital to Daulatabad. Skilled artisans settled in the region and began producing handmade paper, laying the foundation for a legacy that would endure for centuries. Later, in 1681, Emperor Aurangzeb moved his court to Aurangabad to lead his Deccan campaigns. He invited Persian artisans to enrich the tradition and mandated that Mughal farmans (royal decrees) and manuscripts be written on Kagzipura's paper.



During our visit, we witnessed this centuries-old process firsthand, in a modest, run-down shed. A tenth-generation paper-maker, Mohd Altaf, stood over a large vat, stirring soaked cotton rags into a thick pulp. This pulp was then transferred into a shallow pit, where grass mats were dipped and lifted to form sheets of paper. The thickness of each sheet depended on how deeply the mats were immersed, determining its GSM.



Once formed, the sheets were carefully hung out to dry, then smoothened through an effective ironing process. We also saw paper in a variety of vibrant and earthy hues, created using natural dyes mixed into the pulp.

The paper-making process is entirely eco-friendly, using waste cloth, cotton rags and plant fibres, aligning seamlessly with sustainability and environmental values. The industry faced a decline around 2007 but due to the dedicated efforts of INTACH, in 2017, this fading tradition was revived.

This visit meant more than a stop in our journey, it was a rare glimpse into a living tradition, which was both humbling and inspiring.

Rukmini Amirapu

A Memory I Cherish

It was the early 90s… the National Crafts Museum in Delhi was a "go-to" venue to see not just the museum, but also the craftspersons showcasing their craft and skills in the outer courtyard. Charles Correa had envisioned the concept of an open street with spaces for craft stalls. It was a beautiful environment to display the richness of craft traditions from all over India, with a new set of craftspeople coming in every month.



On one of my visits, I came across a stall of beautifully embroidered textiles from the Kutch region. As I looked around, it was not just the colourful textiles that caught my eye, but the beautiful black and gold shawl worn on the head of the Kutchi craftswoman managing the stall. She sat in the midst of all the mirror work textiles, with the shawl spread out on both sides of her. We talked, and she tried to sell me some of the items, but I wanted nothing but the shawl on her head! I told her I loved it and wanted to buy it. It took some persuasion for her to agree to sell it to me.



While my persuasive skills worked, she had a problem. She explained that, as per custom, unless she had another shawl to cover her head, she could not remove the one she was wearing. Thinking quickly, I decided to part with the simple woollen shawl on my shoulders. We made a deal, and I gifted her my shawl. She deftly slipped it on without exposing her head even for a split second. How I wish I could have made a reel to capture that dramatic moment! But I treasured the moment and, even today, I carry a vivid image of the scene. For me, it was a magical moment.

What I bought was a rare woollen shawl, woven in two narrow lengths to attain the required width. It is black, with broad gold borders on both sides, with a graphic of camels walking the deserts of Kutch. I am not entirely sure, but I understand that it is a Kaanadi veil cloth, originally woven in Porbandar and traditionally worn by Charanjit cattle herders across Kathiawar. Their women wear it too. I was just lucky to meet one who was wearing it!

Rathi Vinay Jha



Judy Frater





Judy Frater, recipient of the Crafts Council of India's Kamala Samman Award in 2010, has been a vital force in the field of artisan empowerment and education. Judy Frater spent over 25 years living and working with the nomadic Rabari community. In 1993, she founded the Kala Raksha Vidhyalaya, India's first design school for traditional artisans, aimed at enabling craftspeople to become designers in their own right rather than mere workers in the craft economy. This initiative later evolved into the Somaiya Kala Vidya, established with the support of the KJ Somaiya Trust.

Her recent book, *Artisans by Design, an Odyssey of Education for Textile Artisans in India,* reviewed in *The Hindu* on March 10, 2026, reflects this lifelong commitment. The book dwells on the Rabari community and its transformative journey into economic empowerment.

The significance of the book lies in its firsthand account of traditional artisans who through education and design training, achieved social and economic status. The book documents the evolution of the Kala Rakshak Vidyalaya from its founding in 2005, to its current form, as the Somaiya Kala Vidya. The book is richly illustrated with over 200 photographs, and tells the stories of as many as 20 artisans, as they transitioned from traditional to contemporary crafting, and the powerful impact it had on their livelihoods.

CCI Crafts Bazaar

CCI's annual Crafts Bazaar was a vibrant celebration of India's heritage, blending traditional arts with modern aesthetics. Featuring 60 artisans including National Awardees and first-time participants, a major highlight was the presence of groups working with women.











CCI Craft Symposium



Participants at the Craft Symposium



Ayyanar terracotta horses, Chettinad

The CCI Craft Symposium *The Future of Handmade*, held to celebrate sixty years of Crafts Council of India, took place at Kanadukathan in Chettinad in February. The historic *VS Madam* provided a beautiful setting for a passionate and forward-looking group of participants from across the country.

The symposium focused on how India, as home to the world's largest living craft traditions, could drive the handicrafts sector in the 21st century and shape its future.

The discussions focused on three areas:

- Training and support for young creative entrepreneurs as they adapt to digital changes
- Building a digital platform like *www.handmade.world* to bring together craft producers, institutions, industry and government
- Finding ways India could lead global discussions on sustainable handicrafts in the context of climate change





Top left: VS Madam*, the venue of the Symposium*

Top right: The exhibition hall of the M.Rm.Rm. Cultural Foundation



On a personal note, I was delighted to welcome friends from the different councils along with like-minded craft enthusiasts to my hometown in Chettinad and share the region's rich craft and architectural traditions with them including Athangudi tile-making, Kottan basketry and Ayyanar terracotta horses.

The vibrant brainstorming sessions at the symposium and the lively conversations outside resulted in many meaningful ideas and identifying clear focus areas that will guide future work in the handicraft sector.

Visalakshi Ramaswamy



Kamala Awards

The Kamala Awards for 2024- 2025 were presented on 21st March, 2026 in Chennai to honour outstanding artisans and individuals whose work reflect excellence, dedication and contribution to India's craft traditions and communities.



The Development Commissioner DCH, Shri Lakshman Rao Athukuri presents the Lifetime Achievement award to Shri B. Krishnamoorthy

Kamala Samman Award for Lifetime Achievement in Craft was awarded to Shri B. Krishnamoorthy, weaver/designer of Kanchipuram sarees.

The Kamala Award for Excellence in Craft went to Shri Khawaja Nazir Ali for Sozni Embroidery from Kashmir and also to Shri K. Srinivasa Rao, woodcraft artisan from Tamil Nadu.

The Kamala Award for Excellence in Weaving went to Shri Doru Lakhabhai Valabhai for Handloom Weaving from Gujarat.



The Kamala Awardees 2024-25

The Kamala Award for Contribution to Crafts was awarded to Shri A.B. Rahman Lone for handweaving of Kashmiri woollen shawls.

The Kamala Award for Revival of Languishing Craft went to Smt Gurinder Kaur Bhullar, Phulkari embroiderer from Punjab.

The Kamala Young Artisan Award went to Kumari Suman Aspura for Hand-knotted Carpet Weaving from Rajasthan.

Tari – The Loom



The 'Tari – the Loom' exhibition was held in April in Chennai. It was a curated exhibition presenting a vibrant canvas of India's artisanal creativity, recognising master weavers, designers and entrepreneurs working with the matchless handloom and weaving crafts of our country.

Among the many unique weaves was a Dhakai Jamdani saree reimagined and recreated based on a 19th century sari displayed at the Indian Museum in Kolkata. The collection from Asal, Gujarat included fabrics made of yarn, hand spun on a traditional charkha, which runs on a single spindle. Natural dyes and revival stories also featured in the textile show.





Crafts Council of Assam

Crafts Council of Assam (CCA) organised a series of skill enhancement workshops, technical training sessions, and design development programmes for artisans across several districts, including Goalpara, Sualkuchi, and Agia. These programmes are specifically designed to create awareness across a range of issues including packaging and labelling and evolving market trends.

CCA participated in the Baisakhi Exhibition providing opportunities to artisans for direct engagement with buyers, resulting in improved earnings and greater visibility for their work.



Awareness Programme on Packaging and Labelling, *in progress*



CCA members with artisans at the Baisakhi Exhibition

Crafts Council of Andhra Pradesh







Krishna Kamalam Praveenya Vikasam craft education programme in municipal schools and orphanages

The Crafts Council of Andhra Pradesh (CCAP) initiated *Krishna Kamalam Praveenya Vikasam (KKPV)*, a craft education programme in municipal schools and orphanages in 2018. Since then, it has been a consistent and impactful initiative carried out every year in Visakhapatnam and Vijayawada. Under the programme, traditional and contemporary crafts are taught by skilled artisans and dedicated CCAP members. The crafts include clay moulding, wheel pottery, Udayagiri cutlery, Cheriyal mask-making and Kondapalli toy-making.

In addition, students have been taught crochet, embroidery and natural dyeing techniques.

Since its inception, this initiative has reached approximately 10,000 students, equipping them with valuable skills and fostering a deep connection to India's craft heritage.





Delhi Crafts Council

In February this year, the Delhi Crafts Council presented *Sandhi* at the India Art Fair—a unique combination of two tribal crafts from Madhya Pradesh and Chhattisgarh. It was a creative convergence of craft skills based on myths and stories carved out by a Gond artist and given material form with Bastar metal craft.



Convergence of Gond art and Bastar metal craft



Phulkari: Stitches Across Time was initiated as a revival project for the slowly declining embroidered textile of Punjab once widespread across the state. In collaboration with the BMW Foundation, a workshop was organised earlier this year under designer Sidhant Minocha. The participants were encouraged to consider how their dreams and experiences could turn into storytelling and also to hone their design process to convert abstract ideas to visual form.





Participants at the Phulkari workshop





Crafts Council of Karnataka





A two-month Design Development Workshop in Kinhal Craft was organised by the Crafts Council of Karnataka in collaboration with Kirloskar Ferrous Rural Development Trust. About 30 designs that emerged from this workshop were subsequently exhibited and sold.

Kinhal craftsman at work



L to R: N. Shashidhara, Mangala Narasimhan, Ekappa Chitragar (MC), Chiranjeev Singh (Chief Guest) K. Somashekar (Designer) and Ratna G. Chitragar (Craftsman)



Shri Raghupathi Bhat, national award winner and master craftsman at the Ganjifa lec-dem

Ganjifa lec-dem: Shri Raghupathi Bhat, a national award winner and master craftsman gave a lecture cum demonstration of Ganjifa cards. These craft-painted Indian playing cards that were brought to India in the 16th century feature artistic designs influenced by Pattachitra, the Epics and Mughal themes.



Crafts Council of Telangana



Smt. Villoo Mirza



Angadi Crafts Bazaar

The Crafts Council of Telangana's (CCT) flagship fundraising event *Aakruthi Vastra* was followed by the presentation of the Samman 2026 Award. This year's Lifetime Achievement Award was conferred on Smt. Villoo Mirza in recognition of her enduring dedication to nurturing the crafts sector.

The Angadi Crafts Bazaar, held in March focused on *The Languishing Crafts of India*. The Bazaar's space became one of reconnection with live demonstrations and interactions with the artisans.

Craft Education: This year group of young participants from the Ashray Akruti Foundation for hearing and speaking impaired children under the *Naipunya Sikshana Crafts in School Programme* wove a perfect 10-metre yardage—a testament to the transformative potential of craft education.



Young participants from the Ashray Akruti Foundation



CCT members with the Samman 2026 Awardees









Top and above: Harijan Tejashibhai Dhanabhai, Tang weaving (camel belt), split ply braiding (Kharad weaving)

Top and above: Koftgiri Damascening, Anil Kumar Sikligar (right)

Crafts Council of Gujarat

The Crafts Council of Gujarat (CCG) organised an AI Training workshop in March specifically customised to address the digital gap. The workshop covered a variety of digital skills essential to modern marketing: market identification, strategic pricing, hands-on smart phone photography for textiles and teaching artisans to shoot and organise structured product catalogues.

Another enthusiastically-received segment was exposing the artisans to generative AI tools like ChatGPT and Meta AI, training them to write effective prompts for product description, generate catchy content and attractive product visuals.



Recipients of the certificates at the AI workshop



CCG members with textile designer Shri Pouldas Nagendra Satish





The Intelligence of Working with Fibre: Rediscovering Desi Kapas - *an exhibition on indigenous cotton*

CCG in collaboration with the Lalbhai Dalpatram Museum in Ahmedabad, hosted an insightful evening in April on *The Intelligence of Working with Fibre: Rediscovering Desi Kapas*.

Eminent textile designer Shri Pouldas Nagendra Satish, took the audience on a journey through India's indigenous cotton ecosystems, highlighting how thousands of native cotton varieties have disappeared over time. He emphasised the urgent need to reconnect with *desi kapas* (Gujarati for cotton)—not just as a fibre, but as a living repository of cultural knowledge, ecological resilience, and sustainable agricultural practice.

The accompanying exhibition featured brands that combine awareness of traditional practices with modern sensibilities. It invited visitors to engage with cotton not just as a material but as a narrative of craft, community, and conscious design.

Crafts Council of Odisha







Artisans at the 'Craftsperson of the Week' initiative working on appliqué, stone and clay



The Crafts Council of Odisha's *Craftsperson of the Week* initiative is their weekly event focused on live interactions with a single craft person. Held in Bhubaneshwar, one individual craftsperson is invited every week to exhibit their craft, demonstrate the technique and sell their finished product.

By offering a free exhibition, working and selling space, the programme eliminates marketing cost and allows an artisan to focus entirely on his craft.

It introduces traditional craft to the young urban audience, fostering a sense of pride in their cultural identity.



Crafts Council of Puducherry

The Crafts Council of Puducherry (CCP) held the Pudu Vasantham Crafts Bazaar from 20th to 22nd February 2026. Over 40 national and local artisans showcased diverse crafts and textiles and were honoured with Samman'certificates. The 2025 Pudu Kaivalam Annual Award was given to Shri Jayamurugan, a physically-challenged stonecraft artisan with over two decades of exceptional work.

CCP also held a Bead Jewellery Workshop where participants explored tools, trends and crafting techniques in creating custom earrings and bracelets.





Participants at the Bead Jewellery Workshop



Shri Jayamurugan receives the 2025 Pudu Kaivalam Annual Award



Crafts Council of Tamil Nadu

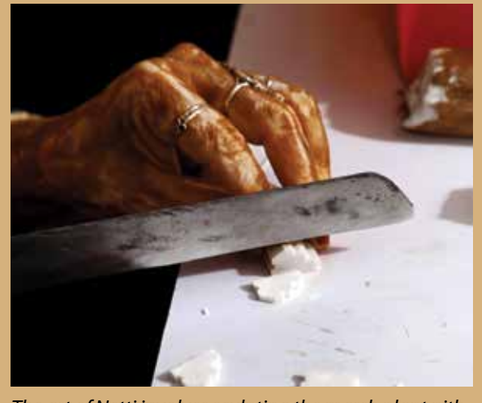
The Crafts Council of Tamil Nadu (CCTN) curated its first ever members craft tour through the Pazhayarai and Thanjavur regions, highlighting several legendary crafts.

At the Thanjavur Palace, members met artisan Nalini Bai and her family who preserve the art of hand-moulded sugar dolls called Sakkara Bommai.



Making of the Sakkara Bommai horses

The tour included visits to artisans Radha and Ezhilvizhi who demonstrated the art of Netti which involves sculpting the marsh plant pith using only a blade and gum, creating intricate temple miniatures used in architecture and wedding décor.



The art of Netti involves sculpting the marsh plant pith



Netti craft temple miniature

Members also met Radhakrishna Sthapathy, maker of the world-renowned Swamimalai bronze idols. They also undertook a cluster visit to a Lambani embroidery cluster in Tiruvannamalai.



CCTN members at the Lambani embroidery cluster



Affiliated State Crafts Councils

CRAFTS COUNCIL OF ANDHRA PRADESH
32-6-12C, Vishalandhra Road,
Prajashakti Nagar, Moghalrajpuram,
Vijayawada - 520 010
Mob: 73307 84849
Email: craftscouncilap@gmail.com

THE CRAFTS COUNCIL OF ASSAM
1/1, Penn Road, Alipore,
Kolkata - 700 027
Tel: 033 46053525
Mob: 98300 75453 - Nandini Dutta
94350 19977 - Jugal Bharali
82915 89259 - Sangamitra Kalita
Email: nandini.dutta1947@gmail.com

DELHI CRAFTS COUNCIL
116-A/1, First Floor, Shahpur Jat,
Near UCO bank,
New Delhi - 110 049
Tel: 92053 66457 / 011 - 4905 5415/2649 1571
Email: delhicraft@gmail.com

CRAFTS COUNCIL OF GUJARAT
004, Ground Floor, Sears Tower,
Patel Society, Gulbai Tekra
Ahmedabad - 380 016
Tel: 82007 78711
Email: craftcouncilgujarat@gmail.com

THE CRAFTS COUNCIL OF KARNATAKA
'Sri Bhooma' No. 37,
17th Cross, Malleswaram,
Bengaluru - 560 055
Tel: 080 2346 2520
Mob: 96202 35041
Email: craftscouncilofkarnataka@yahoo.in

CRAFTS COUNCIL OF ODISHA
At-SURYAPRABHA, 516/1765,
Patia Nandankanan Road, KIIT Area Bhubaneswar,
Khurdha,
Odisha - 751 024
Mob: 99370 37071/93482 43601
Email: craftcilodisha@gmail.com

CRAFTS COUNCIL OF PUDUCHERRY
480/11, Mathur Road,
Pondicherry University P.O,
Opp Tsunami Quarters Kalapet,
Pondicherry - 605 014
WhatsApp: 83009 85450
Email: craftscouncilpudu@gmail.com

CRAFTS COUNCIL OF TAMIL NADU
'Vue Grande', 3rd Floor,
339/C-6, Chinnasamynaidu Street,
New Siddhapudur,
Coimbatore - 641 044
Mob: 99527 78667
Email: cctn.cbe@gmail.com

CRAFTS COUNCIL OF TELANGANA
Lalitha Prasad Floor, CCT Spaces
8-2-686/ 28/1/3/1 MLA Colony, Road No 12,
Banjara Hills,
Hyderabad - 500 034
Phone: 99494 55533
Email: info@craftscounciloftelangana.com

CRAFTS COUNCIL OF UTTAR PRADESH
Arif Ashiana Building, 1st Floor,
Neebu Bagh Chowk
Lucknow - 226 003
Tel: 0522 -2320824
Secretary: Dipali Bose - 97946 36318
Mob: 94502 41106 / 98923 88475
Email: craftscouncilofup@gmail.com
dipalibose2015@gmail.com

CRAFTS COUNCIL OF WEST BENGAL
C/o ARTISANA
13, Chowringhee Terrace, 1st Floor
Kolkata - 700 020
Tel: 98314 26934 - Tanima Sinha, Manager, Artisana
Mob: 85840 79336 Office
Email: craftscouncilofwb@gmail.com

THE CRAFTS COUNCIL OF INDIA
GF, 'Temple Trees',
37, Venkatanarayana Road, T. Nagar,
Chennai - 600 017
Tel: 044- 2434 1456 / 98405 41456
Email: info@craftscouncilofindia.in



Editor: Pushpa Chari